

Study Title: Understanding Users' End for Feature or Enhancement Requests in Open-Source Communities

Purpose: In open-source software communities, users are encouraged to share ideas for improvement, yet these suggestions often remain in informal spaces like community forums, rarely reaching the formal issue trackers where development decisions occur. This part of the study seeks to understand users' experiences, practices, and perceptions surrounding feature or enhancement requests, how they are articulated, tracked, and evaluated by users themselves. Our aim with this study is to understand the traceability of these requests, how ideas evolve from initial discussion to implementation decisions, and how the reasoning for accepting or rejecting suggestions is preserved or lost throughout this process.

Interview Draft:

Introduction and Consent Form

Warm-Up and Ice-Breaker Questions

1. What is your name and how old are you?
2. Where do you currently reside?
3. The highest degree of education you have completed?
4. How long have you been using Moodle OSS?
5. Can you tell me a little about your involvement in Moodle? What do you use Moodle for?
6. What kind of contributions have you made (e.g., reporting bugs, suggesting features, coding, documentation)?
7. Do you use any other open-source software besides Moodle?

RQ1. How do users formulate their feature or enhancement requests?

1. Can you describe the last time you submitted a feature or enhancement request in Moodle? What was the process like?
2. How did you decide what information to include in your request?
3. What motivated you to propose that particular feature or enhancement?

4. How did you structure or phrase your request?

RQ4. How do users understand the relationship between community forums and issue trackers?

1. Where do you usually share your ideas for improvements - forums, issue tracker, or elsewhere?
2. How do you think suggestions move from community discussions to formal issue tracking?
3. Have you ever tried submitting something directly to an issue tracker? What was that experience like?
4. How clear or opaque does the boundary between these spaces feel to you?

RQ2. How do users check if their feature requests have been incorporated?

1. After submitting a feature request, how do you usually check whether it has been acted upon?
2. Have you ever received any clarification questions or feedback on your request from developers, maintainers, or other users? Can you elaborate more about the type of feedback you have received?
3. What kinds of signals or updates help you know that progress is being made?
4. How often do you follow up on your requests?
5. Do you feel acknowledged during this process?

RQ3. How do users perceive the responsiveness of developers or maintainers to their requests?

1. How responsive do you feel developers or maintainers are to user requests?
2. Can you recall a time when you felt your request was heard or ignored?
3. How do you interpret delayed responses or silence from developers?
4. How does responsiveness (or lack thereof) affect your motivation to contribute again?

RQ5. What would make the process of proposing and tracking feature requests more effective for users?

1. What would make it easier or more effective for you to propose a feature request?
2. How could the process of tracking your request's progress be improved?
3. What kind of feedback or updates would you like to receive after submitting a request?
4. How could communities or tools make the process more user-friendly or transparent?

Closing

[Thank the participant for their time and insights. Reconfirm that their data will remain confidential. End recording and debrief. Explain about raffle again and tell them to lookout for an email.]

